

Ganesh Iyer

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Education

Sep 2025–2027 **ETH Zürich**, *Master of Science*,
Robotics, Systems and Control

GPA **5.72/6**

Nov 2021– May 2025 **Indian Institute of Technology Bombay**, *Bachelor of Technology*,
Mechanical Engineering (with Honors) specializing in Systems and Controls,
Minor in Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

GPA **9.87/10**

Skills

Languages Python, MATLAB, C++

Software ROS2, NVIDIA Isaac Lab/Sim/Gym, Git, GitHub, Docker, L^AT_EX

Libraries OpenCV, Pandas, Pytorch, NumPy, Scikit Learn

Internships

June 2025 – **Reinforcement Learning for Quadruped Robot Locomotion**

July 2025 [xTerra Robotics, India](#)

- Researched **quadruped locomotion control** via **guided policy search**, where **model-based control** data guides the **RL policy** during training
- Collected a **3-minute** reference dataset by running a **model-based** controller on the Svan M2 hardware
- Trained an RL policy to **imitate** these reference trajectories (**joint positions, velocities, torques**, foot placements) via **trajectory-tracking rewards**
- Used PPO in **NVIDIA Isaac Gym** with domain randomization for Sim2Real, validated in **MuJoCo**
- Trained NN-based **state estimator** for base linear, angular velocity and base height estimation from **sensor data buffer**, required by the RL Policy
- Deployed on Svan M2 **hardware**, achieving **trot gait** (0.7 m/s forward, 0.5 m/s lateral, 1 rad/s yaw)

May 2024 – **Voronoi Diagram Based Path Planning for Superquadric Obstacles**

Jul 2024 Global Connect Fellowship, Nanyang Technological University | Guide: [Prof Domenico Campolo](#) | [GitHub](#)

- Conducted a comprehensive survey on **superquadrics** and their role in obstacle-based **path planning**.
- Developed a novel algorithm to generate **Voronoi diagrams** for superquadrics and applied **Dijkstra's** algorithm on the resulting graph for efficient path planning.
- Used **image processing** to extract object **point cloud** data from an environment image, fitted superquadrics onto obstacles, and validated on a physical maze of variously-shaped objects
- Benchmarked the Voronoi-based planner against **classical methods** like A* and RRT*, and **heuristic** planners such as genetic algorithms, and a recent state-of-the-art drone planning algorithm in 3D.
- Concluded that Voronoi planning for superquadrics offers **safer**, shorter paths with fewer nodes, **low computational space**, requiring only object **point cloud** from image, and no other parameters.

Publications

Conference Paper Lin Yang, **Ganesh Iyer**, Baichuan Lou, Sri Harsha Turlapati, Chen Lv, Domenico Campolo, **"Path Planning in Complex Environments with Superquadrics and Voronoi-Based Orientation"**, IEEE Conference on Robotics and Biomimetics 2025

Projects

Feb 2026 – **Humanoid Motion Control for Soccer**

Present NomadZ – RoboCup Team, ETH Zürich | nomadz.ethz.ch

- Developing learned motion skills for **Booster K1** humanoid robots in RoboCup soccer
- Retargeted custom-recorded human motion (walking, dribbling) onto the robot using **GVHMR** and **GMR**
- Trained velocity-tracking locomotion and dribbling policies using **Adversarial Motion Priors (AMP)** for natural style, in Isaac Lab (MimicKit)
- Trained a get-up (fall-recovery) policy with **RL** – keyframes guide learning, and a multi-stage **curriculum** adds harder fallen postures in later stages
- Building **Sim2Real** deployment and integrating with the vision and behaviour pipelines

Spring 2026 **Cloth Folding with a Multi-Task Diffusion Policy**

[Robot Learning Course](#), ETH Zürich | [GitHub](#)

- o Assembled a **LeRobot SO-101** arm and collected around **200 teleoperated** demonstrations of folding a square towel in three stages: grasp a corner, first fold, and second fold
- o Trained a **multi-task Diffusion Transformer (DiT)** policy (LeRobot) with **CLIP** vision and text encoders, predicting action chunks from a single wrist-camera RGB feed
- o Deployed on the **real robot** with **asynchronous inference** on a local **RTX 4060 (8GB)** – policy server at 5 FPS, robot client at 15 FPS

Dec 2025 – **Monocular Visual Odometry**

Jan 2026 Mini Project | [VAMR 2025](#) | [GitHub](#)

- o Built a monocular visual odometry pipeline (Python/OpenCV) using **Harris** corners + SIFT, **KLT optical flow** tracking, **PnP** + RANSAC pose estimation, triangulation to recover 6-DoF camera poses
- o Added robust bootstrapping, nonlinear **pose refinement** (Levenberg–Marquardt), re-initialization, and landmark rescaling to handle drift, feature loss, and scale ambiguity
- o Tuned and validated across KITTI, Malaga, Parking, and a custom ETH Polybahn ride dataset, achieving **locally consistent** trajectories. Results can be viewed [here](#).

Aug 2024 – **Koopman/DMD based Control for Non-Linear Dynamical Systems**

Apr 2025 Bachelor Thesis Project, IIT Bombay | Guide: [Prof. Abhishek Gupta](#)

- o Extensively Studied **Koopman theory**, and many data-driven control strategies, including Dynamic Mode Decomposition(**DMD** and **EDMD**), and its control variants(**DMDc**), and **Hankel-based MPC**
- o Applied Koopman Theory to predict dynamics of simple systems (spring-mass, vanderpol oscillators, pendulum), then extended it to a complex **two-link manipulator**
- o Applied Koopman/DMD on simulation data of a planar soft robot to obtain **approximate linear dynamics** in the **lifted space**

Aug 2024 – **Warehouse Drone - E-Yantra, Nation-wide Robotics competition**

Sep 2024 Competiton | [eYRC portal](#)

- o Developed PID control algorithm for roll, pitch,yaw and throttle control of a Swift Pico Drone in Gazebo, with the node files and communication pipeline in ROS2 environment
- o Used **A*** for **motion planning** to **navigate** and control the drone in a **warehouse** simulation
- o Team ranked **40 among 3000+ teams** across the nation participating in eYRC, and among the top 50 teams selected for the **hardware phase**, to implement our algorithms on a Quadcopter

Scholastic Achievements

2024 **Department Rank 2** out of **196** students in Mechanical Engineering, IITB

2023 Awarded the **Institute Academic Prize two times**, for exceptional academic performance in the second and third year among Mechanical Engineering students

Recipient of the **Undergraduate Research Award** for exemplary research work in the second year summer

Achieved perfect **10** Semester Performance Index in **five semesters**: Semester **3,4,5,7** and **8**

Awarded the **Academic Proficiency(AP)** grade for **exceptional academic performance** in **7 courses**

2021 Secured **All India Rank 179** in **JEE Main** among 1.2 million aspirants

Secured **All India Rank 1234** in **JEE Advanced** among 250,000 aspirants

Positions of responsibility

May 2023 – **Teaching Assistant | Introduction to Quantum Physics (PH107)**

July 2023 Prof Alok Shukla, Department of Physics

- o Conducted tutorial sessions for **40+ students** across various departments
- o Covered content and clarified doubts of the students pertaining to **Quantum Physics**
- o Graded the Midsemester and Endsemester answer sheets for the batch and conducted crib sessions

May 2023 – **Student Mentor | Mechanical Department Academic Mentorship Programme**

May 2024 Selected as a part of a 35 membered team out of 125+ applicants based on interviews and peer reviews

- o Mentored **5 sophomores**, helping them strike a balance between academics and extracurriculars
- o Acting as the first point of contact in order to actively bridge the gap between faculty and students

May 2024 – **DCAMP Mentor | Mechanical Department, IIT Bombay**

Oct 2024 An initiative by the Mechanical department to ensure proper career advice for pre-final year students

- o Mentored **4 pre-final year students**, helping them get a better perspective of career opportunities
- o Guided students through their internship season ensuring regular **interactions** and **advice**